CURRENT TOPICS.

MONTREAL *Star*: Importers are beginning to look upon their business very much as a game of chance. "Heads!" they win. "Tails!" one-third to the Crown, one-third to the seizing officers and one-third to the informer.

EDISON'S girl baby is said to have the privilege of expressing her views to the phonograph once in every three months and the record is to be kept for her so that when she becomes a woman she will know what kind of a child she was.

TELEGRAMS from Belgium say that the condition of Empress Charlotte, of Mexico, is now quite hopeless. Her strength is rapidly weakening, and she is expected to die at any moment. The unfortunate woman has never recovered her mind, which gave way on the execution of her husband.

THIS is getting to be a cold world for babies. Owners of tenement houses have a prejudice against them, hotel keepers frown on them, and now a New York court has granted an injunction against the erection of a baby asylum in that city. And yet the baby is a great institution that can't be wiped out.

J. A. VANDYNE, of East Liverpool, O., was recently in St. Clairsville, and from idle curiosity visited the jail. In Gertie Williams, a woman confined there on a charge of murder, he recognized his only sister, who left home mysteriously several years ago and whose whereabouts were unknown until the chance meeting.

LORD WOLSELEY says there is a greater danger now menacing England than the possibility of a foreign invasion—the extravagance of the English women. He has noticed, he says, ever since he was a boy an increase in the tendency of English women to spend a much larger portion of the incomes of their husbands than they were entitled to on articles of attire.

THE Lockport *Journal* fancies that the advantage of the smokeless powder, which has been adopted for use in the Lebel rifle, will not all be on the side of the French, for "they will be in clear sight of the enemy who will be partly shielded from view by the smoke of their own guns." But, as is suggested by the Buffalo *Courier*, will not that smoke prevent the enemy getting a clear sight of the French?

AMONG the passengers on the White Star steamer Britannic were five young men from Oxford University, England, two from Cambridge University, three from the University of Edinburgh, and one from the University of Utrecht. They are all on their way to the College Students' Summer School and Encampment for Bible study, to be conducted at Northfield, Mass., by D. L. Moody.

SAYS Sir Lyon Playfair in *Macmillan's Magazine*: "The protective duties of America remove from us the most formidable competitor in the markets of the world by raising its cost of production. They protect England in all neutral markets and enable us to send even into the United States $125,000,000 of manufactured goods, while they return to us less than $15,000,000 of their manufactures."

A GERMAN doctor has discovered that the masculine heart weighs more and is larger in proportion than the susceptible organ possessed by the gentler sex. This statement is another blow for woman to parry and explain away to her own satisfaction. She has been able to endure the physiological fact that her brain weighs less than tyrant man's, but when it comes to her own pet cardiac region, she hasn't the spirit of a mouse if she submits to any scientific shrinkage of its generous proportions!

THE fungus known as vegetable beefsteak, found on old oak trees, is really nutritious and wholesome. When broiled it is difficult to distinguish it from broiled meat. "There is a slight acid flavor in the fungus when cooked," says the *English Mechanic*, "which adds considerable piquancy to the dish; it is extremely tender, succulent and juicy, and resembles tender steak or tongue in a remarkable manner, the juice it distills being in taste and appearance like gravy from an excellent, broiled rump steak."

PROFESSOR CARTER, in his inaugural address before the British College of State Medicine, gave it as his opinion that every case of fever costs the community $10, and that the annual cost of scarlet fever in England is $2,000,000. When considering the question from this economic standpoint it may readily be understood that the cost of carrying out sanitary improvements and the labor of enforcing right methods of living would be far outweighed by the mere monetary saving which they would effect, without taking sentiment into consideration.

A MECHANICAL scarecrow has been invented. This new invention represents a man of "sportsmanlike" appearance standing with a gun in hand ready to fire at the first intruder. The arm holding the gun is made to move by clockwork, which is enclosed in a strong iron box at its feet, and at the proper elevation it fires a shot louder than an ordinary gun. After the report the arm lowers. The mechanism can be regulated at the owner's pleasure by a regulator like a clock, and only requires to be wound up twice a day. Mr. Wm. Maund, of Shobdon, Hereford, England, is the inventor.

A YOUNG lady of New York amuses herself with humming-birds as pets. They build their nests in the lace-curtains, and have raised little families in the parlor. There are plants for them to fly about in, and every day the florist sends a basket of flowers for them to extract the honey from. They are like little rainbows flying about the room, and they light on the head of their dainty mistress with perfect freedom. She has an especial affinity for the feathered race, and pigeons, canaries and bull-finches are included among her household favorites.

IN a paper by Dr. Arthur Ransome (English), entitled "Some Evidences Respecting Tubercular Infective Areas," attention is called to the frequency with which groups of several cases of deaths from consumption in one family occur in small, badly ventilated cottages situated on damp clay soils. It is dampness and want of ventilation that make a house or group of houses dangerous, and they probably do this, in large part at least, by causing or promoting slight inflammations of the air-passages, sore throats, bronchitis, etc., which lower the vitality of the tissues and so make them fit to support the tubercular bacilli.

THE most beautiful chamber ever seen was one recently fitted up by an English Duke for his bride. Her favorite flower is the daffodil, and it predominates in the decorations. The ceiling and the walls are of a pale, grayish green and gold. The fringe and dado are of dull-gold canvas silk, hand embroidered in white daffodils and narcissi. The chandeliers have for globes opaline glass on the same flower designs. The velvet carpet is gray-green, sprinkled with golden flowers. The furniture is of heavy English oak, carved with winged loves' heads, and the draperies and window hangings are of Spanish lace, in conventional designs of daffodils.

UP to date the last person who has made public a device for utilizing the current of Niagara is John R. Greene, of Oneonta, N. Y., brother of the Rev. Dr. Rufus S. Greene, of Buffalo. His plan provides for a $25,000,000 tunnel from South Buffalo to the whirlpool, giving a fall of 210 feet here, and 320 at the lower terminus. Cross tunnels are included. It is estimated that 500,850 horse power would be provided, which, at a rental of $15, would yield $7,512,750 per annum. The subscriptions for the prize for the best device have reached the sum of $108,000. Erastus Wiman was the last signer.

AN experienced and highly respectable physician gave a valauble hint the other day which others may find a useful hint as I did, writes a correspondent. "I am convinced," said he, "not only from practical personal experience but on theoretically scientific grounds also, that a safeguard against much prevalent summer illness lies in the free use of lemon juice. Citric acid helps to supply the place of the fluids which are unduly dissipated through the pores of the skin in hot weather. Eat plenty of lemons, and you can stand the heat infinitely better than those who do not make use of the fruit which nature has supplied tropical countries."

QUEEN VICTORIA has been unusually successful this year in the sale of her yearlings. They went at an average price of 475 guineas apiece, and a very smart crowd gathered at Hampton Court to bid for them. The Duke of Portland drove his coach from town to the sale, and made the two biggest bids of the day, paying 2,600 and 1,500 guineas respectively for two of St. Simon's yearlings. Lord Randolph Churchill was on hand to bid, as were a lot of other distinguished individuals. Prince Henry of Battenberg did not have the luck of his royal mother-in-law. He sold two hunters at the same sale which fetched 55 and 30 guineas each.

THE gentleman who has just succeeded to the Earldom of Seafield, Scotland, went through some curious vicissitudes a few years ago. He was then in New Zealand, hard pushed to earn a livelihood, and he was acting as a bailiff in the New Zealand town of Oamaru, in 1884, when his father (the uncle of the earl he succeeded) became Earl of Seafield. The news was brought to the bailiff, who was at that moment "in possession" of a house in his official capacity, that he was now Viscount Reidhaven. A substitute was willing to take his place, but the bailiff viscount stuck to his post for other two days. Subsequently he stood for Parliament out there, but was not elected.

IN a recent article on Indian railroads and Indian wheat production, Mr. Samuel Smith, M.P., who is a retired Liverpool cotton broker, makes a statement which possesses some interest for Canadian and American wheat-growers. "It is evident," he says, "that it is to England's interest to do what she can to develop the vast capabilities of India as a grower of wheat, since India accepts British goods in payment for her wheat without any tariff robbery. The cotton famine consequent upon the American civil war led us to encourage cotton-planting in India; and the hostile tariffs of such wheat-growing nations as the United States and Russia are in like manner hastening the day when India shall be the chief granary of the world."

THE deleterious effect of arsenic upon the skin was recently discussed in the Pathological Society of London, after a communication had been read by Mr. Jonathan Hutchinson. The skin is the tissue on which arsenic has perhaps its most marked influence. The poison may spoil the complexion instead of improving it by making it muddy and unsightly. A similar action is exhibited in all parts of the skin, and may lead to the development of soft corns, not warts, on the palms of the hands and soles of the feet, where a roughened condition also grows up under its influence. Mr. Hutchinson expressed the belief that arsenic can produce epithelial cancer.

THE proclamation of Christianity as the national religion of Japan will probably soon be made. The question, according to the Japan *Weekly Mail*, is now under discussion, and many of the leading publicists, statesmen and professors are taking an active part in the discussion. It is not claimed that Christian doctrine, in its purely religious side, is generally acceptable, but it is claimed that Christian civilization and Christian sentiment are gaining the mastery; that the old Japanese beliefs are dead or dying fast; that Japanese ethics are gradually giving place to Christian ethics, and that Christianity has, among other things, this in its favor—that it is the religion of the most highly civilized countries.

REPORTS from Brazil indicate that the freedmen have exhibited a steadiness and industry surprising to the most hopeful, and that many of them are in the employ of their former owners. Leading planters are employing greater numbers of laborers than they formerly owned slaves, are paying their employees fairly and treating them well, and making better profits under the free than the slave labor system. Malcontents among the former slave owners are said to be the only disturbing class, and whatever injurious results may follow the emancipation will, it is confidently stated, be due to these men rather than to the freedmen. The final act of emancipation has apparently been accompanied by much less disturbance than was to have been expected.

As one result of the invasion scare, arrangements are being made at the British War Office for instructing gentlemen of influence in the counties of England and Scotland, and who are willing to accept the duty, to inquire into the extent and efficiency of local transport and equipment for the Volunteers under the mobilization scheme, and also as to the possibility of organizing in some way the many thousand Volunteers who have served a certain time in the ranks and have for various reasons ceased to be active, but who, if occasion should arise, would be willing to serve again. It is known that forty thousand men left the service voluntarily during last year only, and the whole number of such men fit for service has been estimated at over half a million.

THE Mormons do not appear to be disconcerted by the Government prosecutions of polygamists. "We need not be disturbed by the dark clouds," said Apostle Lorenzo Dow of the Latter-day (Mormon) Church, at a recent quarterly conference at Manti, Utah. "There never was a time when we were moving more swiftly in the path of exaltation. Some of the elders have been to the penitentiary, and they came out better looking. How far these persecutions may go it is not for me to know; it is not for me to care. Persecutions become a pleasure to those who suffer for righteousness. It was so with the three Hebrew children. There is no point at which we can say we have suffered enough to receive the rewards that God has promised us. We ought never to say we have had enough."

BY way of commemorating the four hundredth anniversary of the discovery of America by Columbus, the Italian Government has published a decree "that by the care and with the help of the state be published a collection of Christopher Columbus' writings, all of the autographical documents illustrating the life and voyages of the great navigator, the attempts of his predecessors, and the transformation which his work underwent by the further discoveries of other Italian navigators. The collection shall be accompanied by a bibliography of all the works published in Italy relating to Columbus and his discovery from 1492 up to the present time." The decree also names a commission to carry out the purpose, consisting of twenty of the most distinguished historical scholars of the kingdom.

SOME time ago it was announced that a Toronto man had discovered what was believed to be an old picture of the poet Burns by Sir Henry Raeburn, and that he held it for sale at an almost fabulous price. The Glasgow *Mail* now characterizes the discovery as manifestly absurd. "The journals on this side of the water that have accepted the tale as if it might be true," it adds, "must be ignorant of the fact that Raeburn was in his cradle at the time when Burns visited Edinburgh. Indeed, it was in the very same year (1786) in which Raeburn was born at Stockbridge that Burns published his poems, and was preparing to quit his native land when the letter from Dr. Blacklock to Lawrie, of Loudoun, inviting the Mossgiel farmer to the Scottish metropolis, changed the course of the poet's life. The people in the Dominion who are expecting to pocket 2,000 guineas for this so-called Raeburn will most assuredly be disappointed."

THE photographic lens is coming into use as a factor in medical diagnosis, says the New York *Mail*. Like many more important matters, the discovery of its utility in this direction was an accident. Some time ago a photographer on Eighth avenue had as a subject a child apparently in full health. The little one had a ruddy complexion and a clear skin. When the negative was examined, however, the picture showed the face to be thickly covered with blotches. Within a week the child was covered with spots due to an attack of measles. Thus it would seem that the eruption, although invisible to the naked eye, was seen and photographed by the sensitive plate of the camera several days before there was any apparent indication of the disease. It is said that a similar case is on record where a child's picture showed spots on its face two weeks previous to an attack of smallpox, at which time there was not the slightest symptom of the malady apparent.

MICHAEL HEINE, of Paris, left 100,000f and M. Armand 500,000f. to the Philanthropic Society to put up a building to be entirely devoted to the dwelling-rooms of working people in that city. The corner-stone was laid on Friday in the Rue Jeanne d'Arc, near the sugar refinery of Constant Say. It is to be a six-story edifice, with a large court-yard, where children may find plenty of secure play room. There are to be five small apartments on each story, three of three rooms and two of two rooms. Wonderful to relate, these lodgings are to enjoy the unheard-of-luxury of running water, gas and water-closets. The floors are to be made of iron, covered with oak, and on the ground floor are to be stores, where the necessaries of life are to be sold at reasonable rates. The highest rent will be $40 a year, and for such accommodation and comfort as cannot be found at double that elsewhere. If this building can be found to pay its way, other influential and rich men are willing to contribute this much-needed and charitable improvement in the homes of the poorest classes.

MRS. HAMERSLEY, the New York widow who married the Duke of Marlborough on Friday last, is described by the *World* as a superb looking woman, tall and of a commanding figure and a pronounced blonde. She has gone to the opera very frequently during the last two seasons, and her appearance is familiar to those who have been fond of watching the boxes at the Metropolitan Opera House on notable nights. She is the widow of Louis Hamersley, who died about five years ago, leaving a fortune of $5,000,000. The money was left to her during her lifetime, and to go at her death to the male heir of J. Hooker Hamersley, Louis Hamersley's cousin, who at the time was looked upon as a confirmed bachelor. In the absence of an heir, Mrs. Hamersley was directed by the will to divide the $5,000,000, at her death, among well-known charities. Hooker Hamersley remained a bachelor, and there was no prospect of a Hamersley heir until the other day, when he married a young society woman named Miss Margery Chisholm. The pecuniary benefit the Duke will derive from the alliance will be limited to whatever his wife's income amounts to during her lifetime. Another point worth noting is that no male issue of the marriage can succeed to the Marlborough title, as he has a son by his first marriage, now about fifteen years old, enjoying the title of the Marquis of Blandford, which was indeed his father's title until a few years ago.

IN a letter recently delivered before the Franklin Institute Prof. Haupt has been astonishing the world by his calculations on the savings to be effected by rapid transit. He calls the results "intensely practical," and insists that the prosperity of a community is frostered by recognizing the facts he discloses. The *Electrician* says: 'We do not feel quite so sure about it ourselves, but our readers can judge. By doubling the velocity of the street cars in Philadelphia half an hour might be saved for each passenger, and a saving of 23,148 years would annually be effected on the aggregate passengers using the cars. At first we were inclined to suggest that the passenger would save his time altogether by not taking the ride. But the curious professor assumes that everybody must ride or walk, and he evidently is dead against walking, a method of locomotion which involves continuous loss of energy, in New York computed at 8,333,333 horse power. To effect a large economy in this item he proposes to erect fresh thoroughfares, cutting through the existing blocks diagonally. It strikes us that this would drive many people out of their homes and compel them to live farther away from their occupations, a result doubtless profitable to the street cars, but not to the inhabitants. After all, perhaps, both as regards the time saved in riding, and the energy saved in not walking, everything depends on what you do with the savings."

THE Egyptian petroleum explorations on the Red Sea Coast were some time ago suspended. The Government spent in the neighborhood of $750,000 in these explorations, and has nothing to show in return for this very considerable outlay except worn machinery and a few empty holes in the rock at Zeite and Djemsch. The first effort to find petroleum was made in the latter part of 1885 by boring on a small scale at Zeite. A little oil was then found, but that has been the last as well as the first. In the spring of 1886, a geological survey of the region about Zeite and Djemsch and back from the coast was ordered. It would be more appropriate to denominate this survey a petroleum search, but a fatal error was to entrust such search to a man who knew nothing about searching for petroleum. He had no familiarity with petroleum regions, but his report convinced the uninitiated Egyptian officials that the whole earth thereabouts, including the long mountain line between the Red Sea and the Nile Valley, contained inexhaustible stores of petroleum. It was found in even the paving rock of Cairo, taken from the hills overhanging the city. The imaginative explorer found the smell of oil everywhere and the wildest desire possessed the Egyptian official mind to profit at the earliest day from the vast store of wealth with which a wide region of Egypt was saturated. Expert borers were employed and great quantities of machinery were purchased, and under a great strain the works were erected and the boring was begun in the latter part of 1886; but now, the Egyptian petroleum explorations and works are at an end, because no oil could be found to keep them going. Expensive machinery now lies idle in the humid air of the Red Sea coast, where in disuse it will soon become worthless.

THE great undertaking of the Forth Bridge at Queensferry, in Scotland, is this year attracting more than ever the attention of the public. Naturally, there is now more to be seen than at any previous time. During the first year or two of the bridge's construction the great mass of the work was below the level of the sea, and there was little to be seen; but since that part of the work has been completed the public can notice by inspection from the shore to some extent how the work is advancing. It requires now only a very few months' interval between two visits for even the casual observer to notice how the work is going forward. The stage which has at present been reached is, that the new line of railway from North Queensferry to Inverkeithing is well advanced, that a commencement has been made with the new line from South Queensferry to Dalmeny, that the first bay of the cantilevers has been completed, that the second bay at the north and south sides is partially finished, and that the approach viaducts at both the south and the north ends are also completed. The total quantity of steel to be used in the construction of the bridge proper is over 50,000 tons. Up to the present time the total quantity erected in the main spans is between 28,000 and 29,000 tons, besides 3,000 tons in the viaduct approaches. Erecting is going on at the rate of 1,500 tons a month. The material for the upper part of the work is lifted by cranes with steel-wire hawsers from the internal viaduct, while the steel for the lower part is lifted from barges in the water. Six hundred men are employed at each of the three cantilevers, and between the bridge and the works at Queensferry about 3,300 men are employed in all. Work, as heretofore, is carried on night and day.

TICKLED IT WITH A CORNSTALK.

A Roaringly Absurd Love Comedy from Old England.

In a current letter from London appears this novel in a nutshell, the sequel as yet being missing:

The arrest and confinement of Lord James Douglas in Holloway jail is another illustration of the decadence of the British peerage. The offence of Lord James is known in legal phraseology as "molesting" a ward of chancery, an estimable and beautiful girl named Mabel Scott, the unmarried daughter of Lena Lady Scott, with whom, in spite of the express orders of the Court of Chancery, he "communicated." This latter consisted in his sending from some port on the Mediterranean a Christmas card which was held by Justice Chitty to be of a highly objectionable character. No little speculation has been indulged in as to just what the nature of the Christmas card was.

Lady Florence Dixie, the sister of the unfortunate Lord James, in answer to the inquiry as to exactly what the obnoxious card was, said: "Well, in the first place, it is well known that my brother would never behave in an ungentlemanlike manner, especially to a lady—one, moreover, of whom he was very fond. You see on the card which has evoked so much comment a little child of 3 asleep. Two small sprites are looking at her from behind the fence; one is trying to wake her up by tickling her face with a corn-stalk, and both are laughing. What is there improper in such a card? Nothing whatever. I went to Miss Scott's solicitors to look at it, and asked them to let me take it away and get it photographed so that everybody might see it, but they refused."

Miss Mabel Scott, the victim of Lord James' Christmas card, is a head and shoulder taller than Lord James' sister—a thoroughly English type of beauty, with a sweet face and fascinating manners. In the family circle she is known by the endearing name of "Babs."

Human Beings as Pack Animals.

Professor Joseph Le Conte, of the University of California, sends the following information in reply to an inquiry in "Science" in reference to the strength and endurance of the human pack animal: "In 1844 I travelled by birch-bark canoe something like a thousand miles from Lapoint over to the head waters of the Mississippi and down the latter to Fort Snelling, at the mouth of the Minnesota River. We made several portages, the longest being nine miles. We had along two trunks and provisions and bedding for four persons for onemonth. The load which our two voyageurs carried was certainly 150 to 200 pounds each. They made seven miles in one day, going over the ground five times, *i. e.*, thirty-five miles. Three-fifths of the distance they were loaded, and two-fifths going back for another load. Their plan was to take the heaviest load first (about 200 pounds), and carry it about a mile or a mile and a half, put it down, go back for another load of 150 pounds, carry this a mile or a mile and a half beyond the first deposit, then come back, take up the first deposit and carry it the same distance beyond, etc., until all was carried to the camp for the night; then, last of all, they went back seven miles to the last camp, took up the boat (which was the lightest load of all), and carried it to the camp. I will give you an account of one load. They used a leather strap about two inches and a half wide in the middle and narrower toward the end, and perhaps ten or twelve feet long. One fellow, a famous voyageur, would tie this about my trunk (about seventy-five pounds) in two places near each end and throw it over the head, bringing the band across the forehead, the trunk resting on the back, then take 100 pounds of flour and put on the trunk, with twenty-five pounds of crackers on the top of all, and walk off briskly, almost in a trot. The man was not large or very muscular, but rather lean and wiry."

Consumption Surely Cured.

To the Editor:

Please inform your readers that I have a positive remedy for the above named disease. By its timely use thousands of hopeless cases have been permanently cured. I shall be glad to send two bottles of my remedy FREE to any of your readers who have consumption if they will send me their Express and P. O. address.—Respectfully,

DR. T. A. SLOCUM,
37 Yonge street, Toronto, On

SAFETY IN HOUSE DRAINAGE.

The Dangers Involved in Ignorance of Sanitary Principles.

In his census reports, Dr. Billings estimates that, in the United States, one hundred thousand deaths occur every year from strictly preventable diseases alone. This is unquestionably a very moderate estimate, and, if there are reckoned also twelve cases of serious illness for every death, we see what a great amount of suffering results from ignorance or sanitary principles. But how is this ignorance manifested? Are not our architects competent to deal with the problem of household sanitation? It will be said, perhaps, that it is the province of the architect to direct the entire work of house-building, and to arrange every detail of the fittings. But it should be considered that the science of sanitation is broad and comprehensive. Years of study and of experience in sanitary work are necessary for a proper understanding of the subject. It is perhaps unfortunate that there is so little in the severe and unpleasant details of this work to commend it to those whose tastes have led them to the study of the more attractive principles of artistic construction and the science of æsthetics. An architect should have the hand of an artist, but there are few men whose nature is so broad as to combine truly artistic tastes with a love for the details of difficult mechanical work, involving the necessity for undertaking comprehensive and scientific research. It is the province of the engineer to engage in an occupation of this kind. His natural inclinations and his rigid training in scientific pursuits fit him especially for the direction of matters relating to drainage and sewage disposal.—*Popular Science Monthly.*

Mr. Caudle and His Second Wife.

When Harry Prettyman saw the very superb funeral of Mrs. Caudle—Prettyman attended as mourner, and was particularly jolly in the coach—he observed that the disconsolate widower showed, that, above all men, he knew how to make the best of a bad bargain. The remark, as the dear deceased would have said, was unmanly, brutal, but quite like that Prettyman. The same scoffer, when Caudle declared, "he should never cease to weep," replied, "he was very sorry to hear it; for it must raise the price of onions." It was not enough to help to break the heart of a wife; no, the savage must joke over its precious pieces.

The funeral, we repeat, was remarkably handsome: in Prettyman's words, nothing could be more satisfactory. Caudle spoke of a monument. Whereupon Prettyman suggested "Death gathering a nettle." Caudle—the act did equal honor to his brain and his bosom—rejected it.

Mr. Caudle, attended by many of his friends, returned to his widowed home in tolerable spirits. Prettyman said, jocosely poking his two fingers in Caudle's ribs, that in a week he'd look "quite a tulip." Caudle merely replied—he could hardly hope it.

Prettyman's mirth, however, communicated itself to the company; and in a very little time the meeting took the air of a very pleasant party. Somehow, Miss Prettyman presided at the tea-table. There was in her manner a charming mixture of grace, dignity and confidence—a beautiful black swan. Prettyman, by the way, whispered to a friend, that there was just this difference between Mrs. Caudle and his sister—"Mrs. Caudle was a great goose, whereas Sarah was a little duck." We will not swear that Caudle did not overhear the words; for, as he resignedly stirred his tea, he looked at the lady at the head of the table, smiled and sighed.

It was odd; but women are so apt! Miss Prettyman seemed as familiar with Caudle's silver tea-pot as with her own silver thimble. With a smile upon her face—like the butter on the muffins—she handed Caudle his tea-cup, Caudle would, now and then, abstractedly cast his eyes above the mantle-piece. There was Mrs. Caudle's portrait. Whereupon Miss Prettyman would say, "You must take comfort, Mr. Caudle, indeed you must." At length Mr. Caudle replied, "I will, Miss Prettyman."

What then passed through Caudle's brain we know not; but this we do know: in a twelvemonth and a week from that day Sarah Prettyman was Caudle's second wife—Mrs. Caudle number two. Poor thing!

MR. CAUDLE BEGINS TO "SHOW OFF THE FIEND THAT'S IN HIM."

"It is rather extraordinary, Mrs. Caudle, that we have now been married four weeks—I don't exactly see what you have to sigh about—and yet you can't make me a proper cup of tea. However, I don't know how I should expect it. There never was but one woman who could make tea to my taste, and she is now in heaven. Now, Mrs. Caudle, let me hear no crying. I'm not one of the people to be melted by the tears of a woman; for you can all cry—all of you at a minute's notice. The water's always laid on, and down it comes if a man only holds up his finger.

"You didn't think I could be so brutal? That's it. Let a man only speak, and he's brutal. It's a woman's first duty to make a decent cup of tea. What do you think I married you for? It's all very well with your tambour-work and such trumpery. You can make butterflies on kettle-holders; but can you make a pudding, ma'am? I'll be bound not.

"Of course, as usual; you've given me the corner-roll, because you know I hate a corner-roll. I did think you must have seen that. I did hope I should not be obliged to speak on so paltry a subject; but it's no use to hope to be mild with you. I see that's hopeless.

"And what a herring! And you call it a bloater, I suppose? Ha! there was a woman who had an eye for a bloater, but—sainted creature!—she's here no longer. You wish she was? Oh, I understand that. I'm sure, if anybody should wish her back, it's—but she was too good for me. 'When I'm gone, Caudle,' she used to say, 'then you'll know the wife I was to you.' And now I do know it.

"Here's the eggs boiled to a stone again! Do you think, Mrs. Caudle, I'm a canary-bird, to be fed upon hard eggs? Don't tell me about the servant. A wife is anwerable to her husband for servants. It's her business to hire proper people: if she doesn't, she's not fit to be a wife. I find the money, Mr. Caudle, and I expect you to find the cookery.

"There you are with your pocket-handkerchief again,—the old flag of truce; but it doesn't trick me. A pretty honeymoon? Honeymoon? nonsense! People can't have two honeymoons in their lives. There are feelings—I find it now—that we can't have twice in our existence. There's no making honey a second time.

"No: I think I've put up with your neglect long enough: and there's nothing like beginning as we intend to go on. Therefore, Mrs. Caudle, if my tea isn't made a little more to my liking to-morrow—and if you insult me with a herring like that—and boil my eggs that you might fire 'em out of guns—why, perhaps, Mrs. Caudle, you may see a man in a passion. It takes a good deal to rouse me, but when I am up—I say, when I am up—that's all.

"Where did I put my gloves? You don't know? Of course not; you know nothing."—*Douglas Jerrold's Fireside Saints.*

MORE MOTHER THAN WIFE.

Some Unpleasant Phases of Excessive Maternal Love.

There are two distinct kinds of women in the home—the one more wife than mother, the other more mother than wife. We all know houses where the woman either sacrifices the husband to the children or the children to the husband. Sometimes she sacrifices both to herself, and sometimes the husband joins hands with her in her "philoprogenitiveness" and makes the nursery the Delos of the house and the school-room the Mecca of the life. In which case unfortunately the chances are that the children are spoiled by being made too much of—whereby they become selfish and self-considering—while the interests of the parents, narrowed down to the dimensions of the home only, cause their intellects to suffer from the rust of disuse and the mildew of stagnation. They become socially dull, and tiresome as companions. They are unable to talk of books or pictures, of politics or music, of science or travel—in short, of things of any general interest. They can talk only of their children; and the smallest events connected with them take the dimensions of imperial interests on which hangs the fate of thousands. As infants you hear of their maladies, or, it may be, while still unable to guide their hands to their mouths, of their sharpness and intelligence. Grown older and able to talk in that mysterious tongue which no one not initiated understands, you hear of profound remarks proving a depth of philosophy which promises a future Plato, to say the least of it. Grown older still, their prowess in the cricket field, their successes at school, their superior attainments generally form the staple of parental conversation—of all the life of the father and mother—and when the last of the nestlings' plumage has been shed—the last chip of the egg-shell has fallen off—and the children have become the young people of their generation, that parental interest increases rather than diminishes, and the absorption is even greater. When the husband does not join hands with a wife who is more mother than wife, he has a bad time of it. To the ordinary man children are delightful playthings while they are little—leeches to be fed with the blood of gold, when, grown older, they need much and demand more. But for the most part they occupy a subordinate place in real life, and are included in the mass rather than made the apex of the whole. To such a man as this their advent often proves but a questionable kind of blessing if his wife is one with whom the children eclipse the husband. He married for personal companionship, for sympathy of tastes and pursuits, for general pleasantness of association; and for the first few months he seemed to have found all that he desired. His wife was sweet and complaisant; ever ready to walk with him, ride with him, read with him, listen to him, talk to him—ever ready to be the companion he had pictured to himself as the summit of human happiness. The first child destroyed the whole scheme and broke up the plan of his life—dispelling forever the rainbow-colored dreams which youth and love had woven for him. The woman he had married was more mother than wife; and, from the moment of its birth, "baby" became the centre of her existence, and the nursery was the throne-room of the house. Henceforward the husband was but as a dead planet revolving in its place, giving no joy, and of use only as a part of the general order, not as the great radiating sun of the whole system. Nothing now can be done as heretofore. With the nervousness of a young mother, baby's existence seems to her to be daily and hourly threatened, and death is warded off only by incessant care. So far from feeling that nature is strong and the forces of conservation more powerful than those of destruction—given the most ordinary wisdom of management—the young mother thinks that on her unsleeping vigilance alone hangs the frail thread of life, and that if she relaxes for a moment the enemy will be upon her darling and the great thief will have stolen her treasure. The dinner has to wait if baby has not gone to sleep—who knows what direful mischance may not ensue on this irregularity of the little creature's repose? There can be no music in the evening because the piano might awake the baby—who would sleep like a top in the midst of a battle or in the heart of a storm. Even voices must not be raised too high, laughter must not be too loud, doors must not be slammed with too brusque a motion—nothing must be done void of the one thought—not to awake baby. The husband's whole home life is revolutionized. His cigar is taken away from him—smoke is bad for baby: and to kiss baby with a tobacco-tainted breath is to poison it. Did not a certain American mother write her experiences in this direction? Was not her child continually poisoned by its father who smoked and played with it afterwards? And did he not give up his pernicious nicotine for the sake of the more precious life? So it goes on, and the husband sinks into insignificance—going farther and farther down in the heaven, where once he had been the vertical sun, till finally he passes out of sight below the horizon, and the wife cares for him no more than for a pair of hands capable of writing cheques which keep the house going. As time goes on and the olive branches increase the mother becomes more and more absorbed in her children, and the wife dies daily more entirely to her husband. She keeps her sons at home as long as she can, and coddles them out of all reason and manliness. She dresses them esthetically, and takes care that their hair shall be long and curling. When the time finally comes for the day school—which dreaded time she cannot longer postpone—she keeps them at home on the slightest pretense and makes the master's life a burden to him by reason of her remonstrances against the length of their tasks and the severity of his impositions. When they have finally to leave her for a more vigorous state of things she prejudices their standing in the school by the absurd precautions which she takes for their isolation from all chances of evil, and the spirit of exclusiveness of superiority, of stand-offishness that she has so diligently fostered in them. If her sons escape the pits she has dug for them and turn out passable men, then are they to be congratulated on a good fortune not granted to all. It is the same with her daughters. When grown up and introduced, their pleasures count for more than her husband's wishes, health, happiness and very life—and she would rather he went bare of necessaries than that they should want superfluities.—*London Queen.*

The genial autocrat is not appreciated by everybody in his own town. One day an American gentleman went into a barber's shop as Dr. Holmes was going out. "Do you know who that was that just went out?" asked the barber. Being curious to see what account of Dr. Holmes the barber would give, the visitor shook his head "Why," said the barber, "that's old Dr Holmes." "And who is Dr. Holmes?" "Oh, he's been a doctor here a great ma years. I believe he ain't practicin' more, but he's thought a good deal of."